

CSE-200 Presentation

Topic: Participatory Design Method

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Participatory Design Method

Introduction & Core principles

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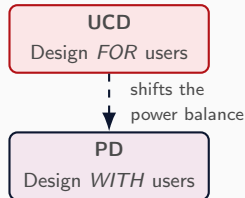
September 9, 2026

Introduction & Core Concept

What is Participatory Design (PD)?

An approach where **users, workers, and stakeholders** actively co-create the design **with** designers, instead of simply being studied or designed *for*.

- Treats users as **design partners**, not test subjects
- Blends **tacit knowledge** of real users with design expertise
- Foundation for modern **design patterns** & co-creation methods

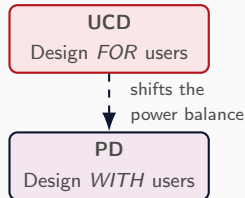


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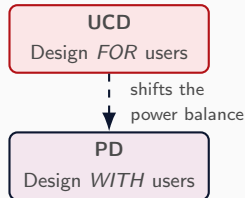


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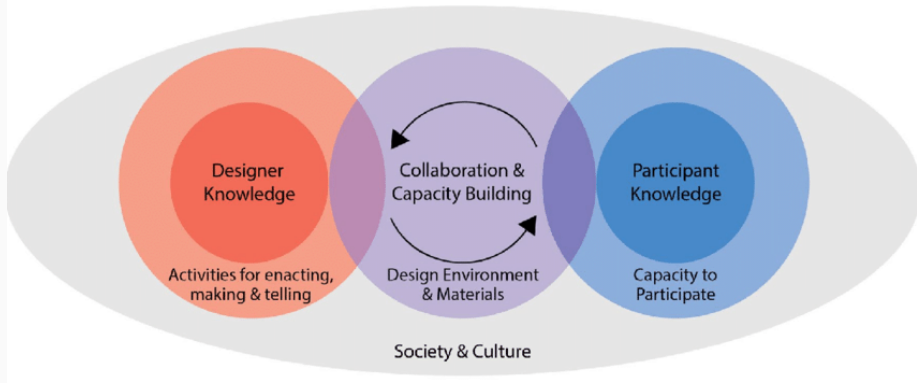
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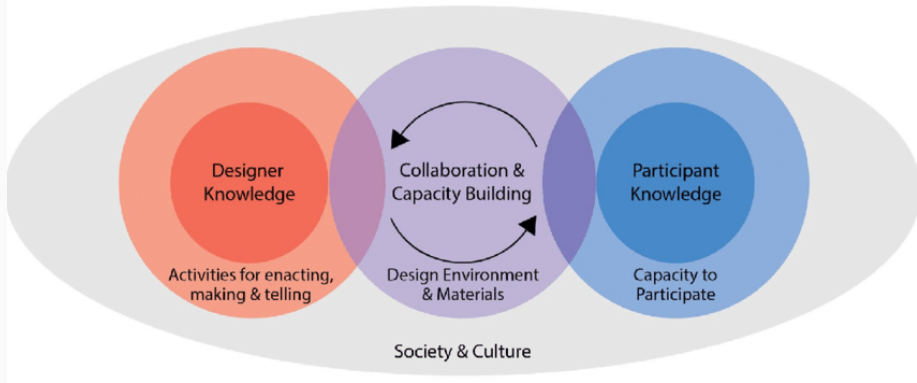
The Collaboration Model: How Knowledge Meets



In simple words

Designers bring **professional design knowledge**; participants bring **lived, real-world knowledge**. Where the two overlap, real **collaboration and capacity-building** happens – supported by shared materials and a design environment, all inside a wider **society & culture**.

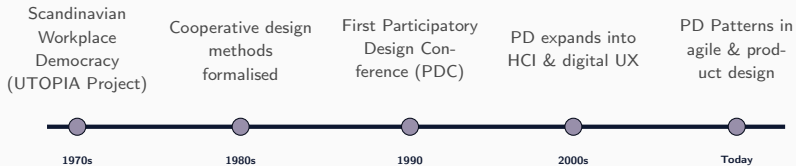
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Historical Context & Evolution



Key milestone

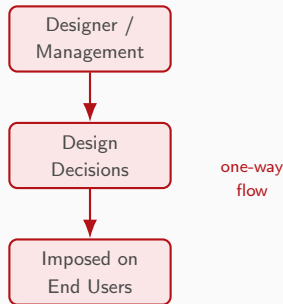
The **UTOPIA Project (Scandinavia, late 1970s–80s)** united Nordic trade unions with researchers to let *typesetters* co-design their own new computer tools – the origin of PD.

The Problem Before Participatory Design

Top-down, designer-centric era

Decisions flowed in **one direction only** – from experts down to the people who actually used the system.

- Management & designers decided **alone**
- Users' real needs, context, and expertise **ignored**
- Feedback arrived only **after** launch – too late



Result

Poor usability, low adoption, workplace resistance, and tools that solved the *wrong* problem.

The Problem Before Participatory Design

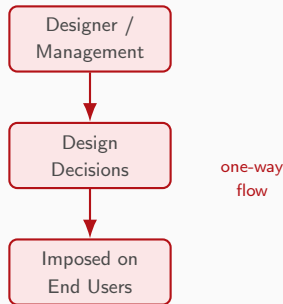
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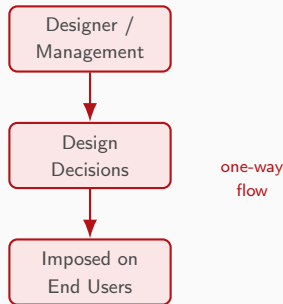


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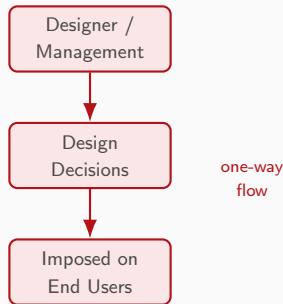
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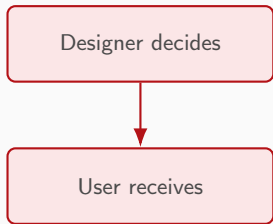


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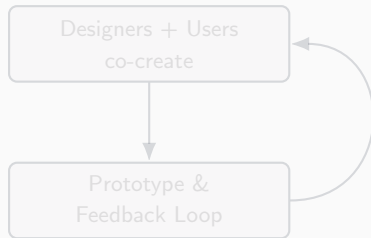
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How Participatory Design Solved It

Before: Top-Down

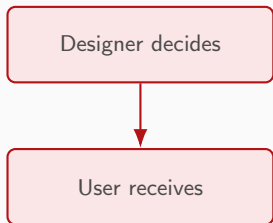


After: Participatory

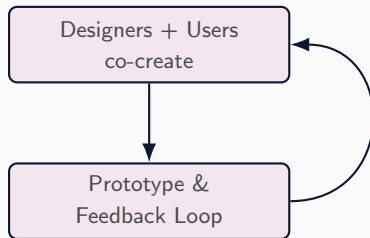


How Participatory Design Solved It

Before: Top-Down



After: Participatory



What changed

Empowerment replaced imposition: stakeholders gained a **real voice and decision power**, and design became an **iterative, cyclical conversation** rather than a one-time handoff.



Mutual Learning

Designers learn the domain; users learn design thinking.
Knowledge flows both ways, building shared understanding.



Co-creation & Ownership

Build it together, so it feels like theirs.

Shared ownership leads to stronger buy-in and better outcomes.



Iterative Prototyping

Small steps and testing, not one big launch.

Rapid cycles of build–test–refine keep design grounded in reality.



Democratic Decision-Making

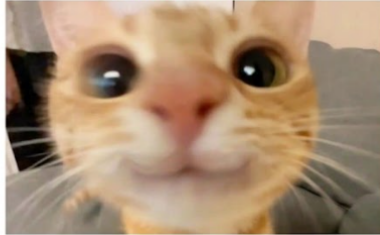
No single voice controls everything.
Every stakeholder has an equal seat at the table.

Same Idea, Explained by a Cat

**DESIGNING *FOR*
USERS (UGH)**



**DESIGNING *WITH*
USERS (YAY)**



Because sometimes a grumpy cat explains user research better than a slide ever could.

Next: Asef will cover processes and techniques of implementing Participatory Design Method.